Daniel Okafor-Reyes

Backend Engineer | Java, Kotlin, Event-Driven Services

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with professional experience since 2019 building production backend services in Java and Kotlin with Spring Boot. Experienced with REST APIs, PostgreSQL, Kafka, automated testing, Kubernetes-based deployments, and on-call operations. Interested in moving into Python-focused backend development; Python experience to date is limited to scripts for data fixes and small Jenkins helpers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Kotlin; Python (scripts for data fixes and small Jenkins helpers); Go (learning; personal CLI project).
Backend and APIs: Spring Boot, REST APIs, OpenAPI 3, versioned APIs, rate limiting.
Data and messaging: PostgreSQL, Oracle, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ, transactional outbox pattern, idempotent consumers.
Testing and tools: Testcontainers, Spring Cloud Contract, Docker, Jenkins helper scripts.
Cloud and platforms: Kubernetes (EKS), AWS EKS, S3 and SQS (service user).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer, Tejo Insurance Tech *2022-Present*

- Designed a versioned REST API using OpenAPI 3 for insurance brokers; added per-partner rate limiting and contract tests with Spring Cloud Contract. The API supports 12 broker partners and approximately 400,000 quote requests per month.
- Fixed duplicate claim records caused by at-least-once Kafka delivery by implementing a transactional outbox pattern and idempotency keys on consumers; duplicate claims fell from approximately 40 per week to zero over the following quarter.
- Built an internal policy-document service in Kotlin and Spring Boot to render PDFs from templates; it was the company's first Kotlin service, and I wrote the team's Kotlin coding guidelines.
- Participate in an on-call rota one week per month; handled a major Kafka lag incident in March 2024 and wrote a post-incident report that was praised.
- Run the backend guild meeting every two weeks, a responsibility I have held since 2024.

Software Developer, Viajar Online *2019-2021*

- Worked on the booking and payments parts of a large Java application.
- Raised payments-module test coverage from 35% to 70% using Testcontainers, enabling safer refactoring.
- Extracted email and SMS notifications from the booking monolith into a separate Spring Boot service, using RabbitMQ for messaging and Thymeleaf for templating.

ADDITIONAL PROJECT

OpenAPI Spec Diff CLI | Personal learning project

- Building a Go command-line tool to diff OpenAPI specifications; approximately 600 lines of code and available on GitHub. This is a learning project, not a production service.

CERTIFICATION

Oracle Certified Professional, Java SE 11 Developer | 2020

LANGUAGE

English: Used as the working language at Tejo Insurance Tech.